# Walker Buehler

RHP · SD · 2026 · 2,615 pitches

**Family 4+: Mid-High slot, rides over**

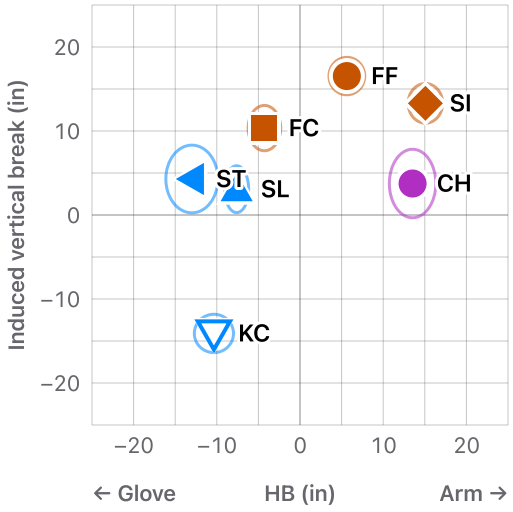
4+ | 45° Slot | 90% Efficiency | +5° Tilt | 23 BU Spin

Mid-High slot, rides over  Reference: Four-seam

12:45

Mid-high slot (46°) with a four-seam that rides over the slot (+5°), spun with typical efficiency (90% efficient), with low spin for its velocity (23 BU).

## Arsenal Movement




Averages with one-standard-deviation ovals. Drawn from behind the pitcher: arm side is to the right.

## Top Recommendations

- ● Four-seam: Ceiling 97, now 86 (gap +11). The best reachable shape is 19.0 in IVB and 5.0 in arm side. Main lever: grip / seam orientation. The seam effect is in the 16th percentile of comps who throw it. Confidence: High (25 comps).
- ● Slider: little room left from the current setup (Ceiling 107, now 107). Confidence: High (15 comps).
- ◐ Sinker: Ceiling 110, now 97 (gap +13). The best reachable shape is 13.0 in IVB and 18.0 in arm side. Main lever: grip / seam orientation. The seam effect is in the 50th percentile of comps who throw it. Confidence: Medium (8 comps).

## Top Five Comps

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Davis Daniel (2023) | 4+ \| 45/90/+5/23 | 98 |
| Elieser Hernández (2021) | 4+ \| 45/90/+5/23 | 96 |
| Logan Allen (2023) | 4+ \| 45/90/+5/24 | 95 |
| Luis Patiño (2022) | 4+ \| 45/90/+5/24 | 94 |
| Valente Bellozo (2024) | 4 \| 45/90/+5/23 | 94 |

## Every Pitch: Today and Potential

| Pitch | Usage | Velo | Spin | IVB | HB | Stuff+ | Ceiling | Gap | Main Lever | Conf. |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Cutter** | 24% | 90.4 | 2370 | 10.3 | −4.3 | 108 | 112 | +5 | Grip / Seam Orientation | ◐ |
| **Four-seam** | 20% | 94.0 | 2180 | 16.5 | 5.6 | 86 | 97 | +11 | Grip / Seam Orientation | ● |
| **Sinker** | 20% | 94.2 | 2094 | 13.3 | 15.1 | 97 | 110 | +13 | Grip / Seam Orientation | ◐ |
| **Slider** | 11% | 87.1 | 2464 | 3.1 | −7.6 | 107 | 107 | 0 | Hand Position at Release | ● |
| **Changeup** | 9% | 89.3 | 1226 | 3.7 | 13.5 | 99 | 110 | +11 | Spin Rate on This Pitch | ◐ |
| **Knuckle curve** | 8% | 78.3 | 2469 | −14.1 | −10.3 | 97 | — | — | — | ○ |
| **Sweeper** | 7% | 82.5 | 2657 | 4.3 | −13.0 | 109 | 113 | +4 | Grip / Seam Orientation | ○ |

Velocity in mph, spin in rpm, movement in inches (IVB: induced vertical break; HB: horizontal break from behind the pitcher, arm side positive).

## Confidence and Data Notes

Stuff+ is Spin ID's own model, not FanGraphs Stuff+. 100 is the 2021–2024 average pitch. Ceiling: what this pitcher's comps do with each pitch, at this pitcher's own velocity and release; Gap is Ceiling minus today; the lever is the change that adds the most. Fastballs keep their natural spin.

Confidence (● High, ◐ Medium, ○ Low) is how much real MLB data sits behind each estimate. Estimates, not promises.

Validity test T5 passed: Stuff+ in 2025 lined up with 2026 results at r = 0.21, better than velocity alone (0.09) and 2025 results (0.09), over 1,247 pitches.

Tested (T4, 2025 to 2026): bigger gaps came with only slightly bigger next-season Stuff+ gains (partial r 0.07; the range includes zero), so treat a gap as a direction to explore, not a forecast.

2026 season: 2,589 pitches with a pitch type; the Spin ID comes from 523 four-seams. Comps are the nearest Spin IDs (slot, efficiency, tilt offset, spin) among MLB pitcher-seasons 2021–2026.